D Mich 3 Grammar notes

Object pronouns look back in the E and F pamphlets for more detail

- **Direct Object pronouns:**
  - **me, te, le/la, nous, vous, les**
- **Indirect Object pronouns:**
  - **me, te, lui, nous, vous, leur (+ y + en)**
- **Disjunctive pronouns:**
  - **moi, toi, lui/elle, nous, vous, eux/elles**

- Direct object pronouns are used to refer to **PEOPLE** and **THINGS** for **verbs that do not involve a preposition**. They are placed before the conjugated verb or infinitive. When used in the perfect tense, they will cause a PDO agreement with past participles.
  - *je les aime beaucoup* — *tu les as vus?*
  - *La chaise? je l'ai mise ici.* — *nous les avons perdus*

- Indirect object pronouns are used to refer to **PEOPLE** only for **NON-REFLEXIVE verbs that involve the preposition "à".** "**Y**" is used to refer to things for such verbs. They are placed before the conjugated verb or a dependent infinitive. No PDO agreement is caused as they are not "direct"
  - *je lui ai donné le cadeau* — *tu leur as parlé?*
  - *Il ne m'a pas parlé* — *nous lui avons téléphoné*

- Disjunctive pronouns are used to refer to **PEOPLE** only for **verbs that involve the preposition "de"** (**EN** is used for things) and **REFLEXIVE * verbs that involve the preposition "à"** (**Y** is used for things). Unlike the other two sets of pronouns, disjunctive pronouns are placed after the preposition that necessitates their use.
  - *je me méfie de lui* — *tu te souviens d'eux?*
  - *elle s'est approchée de moi* — *vous vous adressez à elle?*

*** PENSER/VENIR/COURIR/ALLER/FAIRE ATTENTION à qn – exceptions – they use the disjunctive pronouns:** *je pense à toi, viens à moi!, il a couru à elle…*

- **Y and EN are both indirect object pronouns**, so never cause any sort of PDO agreement with past participles. Though they have several uses, here are some of the main ones:

- **Y means THERE** and refers to a place. It goes in the usual position.

  - *Tu y vas ce soir? Non, j'y suis allé hier.*

- **Y can also refer THINGS** (not people) for verbs that use the preposition "à":

  - *Je m'y habitue* *Je m'y suis abonné*

- **EN often means "of it", "of them", "some", or "any".**

  - *Du vin? J'en bois souvent.* *J'en ai trop bu.*

- **Any use of a number or quantity in French must use "EN"** if the actual item being counted is not specified. It is not possible to say "~~*Elle veut trois*~~" or "~~*combien avez-vous acheté?*~~"

  - *Elle veut trois pommes* *Elle en veut trois*
  - *Vous avez acheté combien de pommes?* *Vous en avez acheté combien?*

- **EN can also refer to things** (not people) for verbs using the preposition "de":
  See page 29/30 and page 48 of the F pamphlet for more information.

Superlatives

- To use **a superlative (the bigGEST, the MOST interesting),** simply place "**LE/LA/LES PLUS** before the **ADJECTIVE** (agreeing with the noun), wherever it comes. Full details are given in page 24 of the F pamphlet, including irregular forms.

  - *le livre le plus intéressant - la plus petite fille - les moins grandes chaises*

- If with your superlative you want to say "**IN the world, IN the room**" etc, French uses **DE** rather than "dans".

  - *La plus jolie fille de la classe*
  - *Le journal le plus lu du monde*

- If with your superlative you want to say "**that + verb**" you will need a special form of the verb called the **subjunctive***. This will be covered later on but for now you can just learn a few useful examples:

  - *que j'**AIE*** *jamais vu* (the past participle will need to agree see p. 18 of the F pamphlet)
    that I have ever seen
  - *que je **CONNAISSE****
    that I know
  - *C'est la plus jolie maison que j'aie jamais vue (PDO)*
  - *C'est le garcon le plus intelligent que je connaisse.*